work on a speech I hoped would tread a fine line, one reiterating our sense of realism and toughness regarding the Soviets, but not offensive enough to torpedo whatever prospects of success there might be for the meeting with Gromyko. I settled on a direct appeal to the Soviets that, while pointing out our concern for their misbehavior in Afghanistan and other places, requested that they return to the Geneva talks and suggested changes in the format of the negotiations to raise their prospects of success. At a reception the night before my speech, Gromyko and I saw each other briefly in a receiving line, and as I looked into his gray face he reminded me of all the Soviet leaders I'd ever seen or heard about in the past: He was tough, stiff, and unsmiling, with no apparent sense of humor unless he had concealed it somewhere beyond his steely eyes. We kept matters cordial and he reminded me that we had once met in California when I was governor. The next day when I gave my speech, he sat with the Soviet delegation front row center just below the microphone. I tried to catch their eyes several times but they looked right through me and their expressions never changed.

The day before my meeting with Gromyko at the White House, the NSC, by coincidence, scheduled a briefing on Soviet espionage at our embassy in Moscow. I was overwhelmed by what Soviet spies had accomplished, including making high-tech alterations to the typewriters in the embassy that had transmitted to them copies of many top-secret documents typed at the embassy.

This is how I recounted my session with the Soviet foreign minister the next day:

Sept. 28

The big day—Andrei Gromyko. Meeting held in Oval Office. Five waves of photographers, first time that many. I opened with my monologue and made the point that perhaps both of us felt the other was a